MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PROJECTILE, 8 INCH, HE, RA, XM650E5
PROPELLANT GRAIN FOR

This specification is approved for use by US Army Armament Research and Development Command, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This military specification covers the rocket motor propellant grain for the 8 Inch Rocket Assisted Projectile, XM650E5.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-F-320	- Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container grade) and Cut Shapes
PPP-T-60	- Tape, Packing, Water Proof
PPP-T-76	- Tape, Pressure Sensitive Adhesive paper, Water Resistant (for carton sealing)

MILITARY

MIL-B-117	- Bag, Sleeve and Tubing - Interior Packaging
MIL-C-13609	- Casting Solvents for OIO, OGK, and AHH Propellants
MIL-C-45662	- Calibration System Requirements
MIL-P-60432	- Propellant Powder, Base Grain, AHH
MIL-A-48078	- Ammunition, Standard Quality Assurance Provisions, General Specification For

FSC: 1320

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, Attn. DRDAR-QA, Dover, New Jersey 07801 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-286 - Propellants, Solid Sampling, Examination and Testing
MIL-STD-453 - Inspection, Radiographic
MIL-STD-652 - Propellants, Solid, for Cannons, Requirements and Packing

DRAWINGS

ARMY

9287966 - Propellant Grain

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.-Materials shall be in accordance with applicable drawings and specifications.

3.1.1 Casting Powder.-The casting powder shall comply with MIL-P-60432 (see 6.4). Except for the requirements for total volatiles and residual solvent this specification shall be advisory for a contractor that produces the propellant grain.

3.1.2 Casting Solvent.-The casting solvent shall comply with MIL-C-13609, Type III. This requirement shall be advisory for a contractor that produces the propellant grain except for the Nitroglycerin content that shall be maintained at ± .10% for each propellant grain lot.

3.2 Propellant Grain.-The inhibited propellant grain shall comply with the requirements specified on drawing 9287966 and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Composition.-The propellant grain composition shall be as specified in Table I.

TABLE I

Ingredient	Percent
Nitrocellulose	53.9 Min
Nitroglycerin	31.6 Nominal
Triacetin	8.8 Nominal
2-Nitrodiphenylamine	0.9 Minimum
Lead Salicylate	1.2 Nominal
Lead 2 Ethylehexoate	2.0 Nominal

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3.4 Heat of Explosion.-The heat of explosion shall be no less than 940 cal/gm and no more than 970 cal/gm when determined as specified in 4.4.3.1.3.

3.5 Strand Burning Rate

3.5.1 Burning Rate.-The propellant shall meet the burning rate specified in Table II when determined as specified in 4.4.3.2.

TABLE II

Temperature °F	Pressure P.S.I.	Burning Rate Inches/Seconds
-40	600	0.359 Minimum
+140	1600	0.581 Maximum
+70	600	Informational
+70	700	Informational
+70	800	Informational
+70	900	Informational
+70	1000	Informational
+70	1100	Informational
+70	1200	Informational

3.6 Cracks, Foreign Material and Porosity

3.6.1 Radiographic Examination:

a. Cracks - There shall be no cracks as shown on the radiograph as dark lines in excess of .06 inches in length.

b. Foreign Material - There shall be no foreign material as shown by bright spots on the radiograph in excess of 0.06 inches in any shape or dimension.

c. Porosity - There shall be no porous areas as shown visually by low density or rounded shadows on radiograph in excess of .03 square inches individually or a maximum combined area of .06 square inches.

3.6.2 Visual Examination:

a. Cracks - There shall be no cracks in excess of .06 inches in length.

b. Foreign Material - There shall be no foreign material in excess of 0.06 inches in any shape or dimension.

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c. Porosity - There shall be no porous areas in excess of .03 square inches individually or a maximum combined area of .06 square inches.

3.7 Inhibitor Separation.-The propellant grain shall contain no individual separation between the inhibitor and the grain (delamination) which is greater than 0.01 square inch. The total combined area of propellant inhibitor separations shall be no greater than 0.02 square inch. There shall be no propellant inhibitor separation within one inch of any split surface.

3.8 Taliani Test.-The rate of evolution of gas from samples subjected to the test specified in 4.4.3.1.2 shall be such that the characteristics of a curve showing rate of evolution (millimeters of mercury versus time) meets the following:

Slope of the curve at 100mm of mercury shall be less than 1.00.
Slope of the curve at 100 minutes shall be less than 0.90.
Time to 100mm of mercury shall be more than 100 minutes.

3.9 Physical Properties.-Compression load and deformation.

3.9.1 Plus 140°F.-The average of three (3) maximum compression readings from each casting shall be no less than 870 lbs., and the average of three (3) deformation readings from each casting shall be no less than 53 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.3.4.

3.9.2 Minus 40°F.-The average of three (3) compression readings from each casting shall be no less than 12,580 pounds and the average of three (3) deformation readings from each casting shall be no less than 5.25 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.3.4.

3.10 Workmanship

3.10.1 Propellant, Grain, Assembly.-The propellant grain assembly shall be free of dirt, grease, chips, gouges, solvent drippings, and other defects which would make the item unsuitable for its intended use.

3.10.2 Inhibitors.-The inhibitors (circumferential and disc) shall be free from dirt, grease, chips, gouges, cracks, and other defects which would make the item unsuitable for its intended use.

3.11 First Article Inspection.-This Specification contains technical provisions for first article inspection. Requirements

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for the submission of first artical samples by the contractor shall be as specified in the contract.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for Inspection and Standard Quality Assurance Provisions.-Unless otherwise specified herein or in the contract, the provisions of MIL-A-48078 shall apply and are hereby made a part of this detail specification.

4.2 Classification of Inspections.-The following types of inspection shall be conducted on this item:

a. First Article Inspection
b. Quality Conformance Inspection

4.3 First Article Inspection

4.3.1 Submission.-The contractor shall submit a First Article sample as designated by the Contracting Officer for evaluation in accordance with provisions of 4.3.2. The First Article sample shall consist of the following items in sample quantities as indicated:

Part Description	Drawings	Quantity
Propellant Grains	9287966	20
Propellant Castings		3
Propellant Grains (Prior to Splitting)		10

4.3.2 Inspections to be Performed.-See MIL-A-48078 and Table I specified herein.

4.3.3 Rejection.-See MIL-A-48078

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TABLE 1 - FIRST ARTICLE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
	Propellant Grain				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
	Propellant Grain (Dwg. 9287966)				
	Examination for Defects	20	-	3.2	4.4.2.1, 4.4.2.2, 4.4.2.3
	Propellant Grains (Prior to Splitting) (Dwg. 9287966)				
	Examination for Defects	10	-	3.2	4.4.2.1, 4.4.2.2

NOTES:

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4.4 Quality Conformance Inspection

4.4.1 Inspection Lot Formation.-Inspection lots shall comply with the lot formation provisions of MIL-A-48078.

In addition each lot of propellant grains shall contain not more than one lot of casting powder. The lot interfix number shall be changed when a new lot of casting powder is introduced into the rocket grain casting processes. A lot shall be no less than 1 weeks production of rocket grains or more than 1 months scheduled production of rocket grains.

4.4.2 Examination.-See MIL-A-48078.

a. Sampling Plans.-Unless otherwise specified in the Classification of Defects and Test Tables, sampling plans for Major and Minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105, Inspection Level II.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-P-63138 (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.1	Inhibitor Prior to Grain Casting				9287966
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None Defined				
Major 101	Thickness of Inhibitor, Cylinder		.40%	3.2	Gage
Minor 201	Evidence of Poor Workmanship		1.00%	3.10.2	Visual

NOTES:

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8

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CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER 9287966
4.4.2.2	Grain, Propellant, Prior to Splitting				NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None Defined				
Major					
101	Total Length		0.40%	3.2	Gage
102	Outside Diameter of Inhibitor		0.40%	3.2	Gage
103	True Position of Inside Diameter to Outside Diameter		0.40%	3.2	Gage
Minor					
201	Inside Diameter		0.65%	3.2	Gage
202	Diameter of chamfer on inside diameter on inhibited end		0.65%	3.2	Gage
203	Diameter of chamfer on inside diameter on uninhibited end		0.65%	3.2	Gage
204	Chamfer on outside diameter missing or improper		0.65%	3.2	Visual
205	Evidence of poor workmanship		1.00%	3.10.1	Visual

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.3	Grain, Propellant, After Splitting				9287966
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None Defined				
Major					
101	Excessive cracks, foreign material or porosity		100%	3.6.2	Visual
102	Exposed propellant at intersections of inhibitor surfaces		100%	3.2	Visual
103	Inhibitor separation		0.40%	3.7	Visual
104	Surface Finish of Saw Cut Surface		0.40%	3.2	Visual
105	Finished Weight of Grain		0.40%	3.2	Balance
106	Missing Spacer		0.40%	3.2.1	Visual
107	Grain X-Ray		Para 4.4.3.3	3.6.1	Visual
108	Web Variation		0.40%	3.2	Gage
Minor					
201	Marking, missing, or improper		0.65%	3.2	Visual
202	Evidence of Poor Workmanship		1.00%	3.10.1	Visual

NOTES:

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF DEFECTS & TESTS

MIL-P-63138 (AR)

PARAGRAPH	TITLE		SHEET 1 OF 1		DRAWING NUMBER
4.4.2.4	Packing				9287966
					NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY
CATEGORY	EXAMINATION OR TEST	NO. OF SAMPLE UNITS	AQL OR 100%	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	PARAGRAPH REFERENCE /INSPECTION METHOD
Critical	None Defined				
Major					
101	Drum split or damaged		0.40%	5.1	Visual
102	Tape missing or improperly applied		0.40%	5.1	Visual
103	Protective bag damaged		0.40%	5.1	Visual
Minor					
201	Marking incomplete or incorrect		0.65%	3.2	Visual
202	Evidence of Poor Workmanship		1.0%	3.10.1	Visual

NOTES:

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4.4.3 Testing

4.4.3.1 Lot Tests:

4.4.3.1.1 Chemical Composition - Major Defect.-Three samples in accordance with 4.4.3.1.4 shall be randomly selected from the lot and tested in accordance with 4.5.1. If any sample fails to meet the requirement of 3.3, the lot shall be rejected.

4.4.3.1.2 Taliani Test - Major Defect.-Three samples in accordance with 4.4.3.1.4 shall be randomly selected from the lot and tested in accordance with 4.5.2. If any sample fails to meet the requirements of 3.8, the lot shall be rejected.

4.4.3.1.3 Heat of Explosion - Major Defect.-Three samples in accordance with 4.4.3.1.4 shall be randomly selected from the lot and tested in accordance with 4.5.5.

4.4.3.1.3.1 Rejection.-If any one of the three samples fail to meet the requirements of 3.4, one sample shall be submitted from each of the six additional different propellant sublots. If any of the six samples fail to meet the requirements of 3.4, the lot shall be rejected.

4.4.3.1.4 Sampling Procedures.-The samples for the tests of 4.4.3.1.1, 4.4.3.1.2, and 4.4.3.1.3 shall be drawn as three samples and then each sample subdivided so as to produce specimens for each of the four tests. If possible, no two samples will be taken from the same casting solvent sublot (mix.).

4.4.3.2 Strand Burning Rate

4.4.3.2.1 Sampling - Major Defect.-Twenty-seven strands shall be formed from each of three different propellant casting sublots and tested in accordance with 4.5.4. Three strands shall be used to determine the average burning rate at each temperature pressure combination as specified in Paragraph 3.5.1.

4.4.3.2.2 Rejection.-If any one of the average strands burning rates from three castings fail to meet the requirements of 3.5.1, six additional propellant castings from different sublots shall be selected. A total of thirty-six strands shall be used to determine the average burning rate at each mandatory temperature pressure combination specified in 3.5.1. If any of the average burning rates from any casting fails to meet the requirements of 3.5.1, the lot shall be rejected.

4.4.3.3 Radiographic Inspection

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4.4.3.3.1 Lot Inspection - Major Defect.-One sample of a completed grain shall be selected from each sublot produced shall be X-rayed. A sublot shall be defined as a group of castings, cast simultaneously from the same casting liquid batch. In the event that the sample grain fails to meet the requirements of 3.6.1, the entire sublot shall be X-rayed and any additional grains failing to meet the requirements of 3.6.1, shall be removed from the lot. This test shall be conducted in accordance with 4.5.6.

4.4.3.4 Physical Properties

4.4.3.4.1 Plus 140°F (see 3.9.1) - Major Defect.-Three samples will be randomly selected from the lot. However, no two samples will be taken from the same casting solvent sublot. These samples shall be tested for maximum compression load and deformation as specified in 4.5.3. The lot shall be rejected if the average of the three specimens from any casting fails to meet the requirements of 3.9.1.

4.4.3.4.2 Minus 40°F (see 3.9.2) - Major Defect.-Three samples will be randomly selected for the lot. However, no two samples will be taken from the same casting solvent sublot. These samples shall be tested for maximum compression load and deformation as specified in 4.5.3. The lot shall be rejected if the average of the three specimens from any casting fails to meet the requirements of 3.9.2.

4.4.4.6 Width of Cut - Major Defect.-The width of cut taken in splitting the grain shall not exceed the drawing requirement. For verification, the width of cut shall be inspected at the beginning of each 8 hours of production by making a partial cut of the grain.

4.4.5 Inspection Equipment.-The inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed herein is described in the 'Paragraph Reference/Inspection Method' column in the tables starting with Paragraph 4.4.2.1. The Contractor shall submit for approval inspection equipment designs in accordance with the terms of the contract. See Section 6 of MIL-A-48078 and Section 6.3 herein.

4.5 Test Methods and Procedures

4.5.1 Composition

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4.5.1.1 Nitrocellulose.-The nitrocellulose content shall be determined in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-286, Method 209.2 or Method 209.6.

4.5.1.2 2-nitrodiphenylamine.-The 2-nitrodiphenylamine content shall be determined in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-286, Method 218.4.

4.5.1.3 Nitroglycerin.-The nitroglycerin content shall be determined in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-286, Method 208.1.

4.5.1.4 Triacetin.-The triacetin content shall be determined in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-286, Method 222.1.

4.5.1.5 Lead Salicylate and Lead 2-Ethylhexoate.-Total lead content shall be determined in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-286, Method T316.1; lead salicylate content shall be determined in accordance with MIL-STD-286, Method 225.1; lead 2-ethylhexoate shall be determined by difference.

4.5.2 Taliani Test.-This test shall be performed in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-286, Method 406.1.

4.5.3. Physical Properties.-Each specimen and specimen support shall conform to the requirements of Figure 1. The compression testing shall be conducted in a test fixture equipped with a temperature conditioning box as an integral part of the fixture. The specimen shall be inserted between the fixture posts with steel cylinders the same diameter as the specimen and placed above and below the specimen forming one continuous concentric cylinder. The specimen shall be conditioned at the required temperature plus or minus 5°F for three hours minimum and shall be tested at a crosshead speed of 2 inches per minute.

4.5.4 Strand Burning Rate (4.4.3.2).-The strand burning rate shall be determined in accordance with Method T803.1 of Standard MIL-STD-286 for test in nitrogen (-40°F) and a Government approved Contractor method for testing in oil (SAE #10, for 70°F and 140°F tests). The strands tested in oil shall be uninhibited.

4.5.5 Heat of Explosion (See 4.4.3.3).-This test shall be performed in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-286, Method 802.1.

4.5.6 Radiographic Inspection.-The split finished machined propellant grain shall be radiographed with the beam parallel to the longitudinal axes of the grain. Observations shall be made for cracks, voids, fissures and foreign material in accordance with MIL-STD-453. A penetrameter or sample test block showing the types of defects for rejection shall be designed to assure a 2 percent minimum sensitivity.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing, Level C.-Eight grains shall be packed in a fiber drum meeting the requirements of DOT specifications 21C of the Code of Federal Regulations Title 49 Parts 100 to 199. The drum wall shall be lined with a kraft backed commercial grade single faced corrugated fiber board using as many layers as required, for a tight pack. The drum size shall be the minimum required to package eight (8) propellant grains packed in two (2) layers of four (4) per layer. A barrier meeting the requirements of MIL-B-117, Type I, Class E, Style 1 shall be placed inside the lined drum. The barrier bag size shall be approximately 31 inches long by 31 inches wide. Each grain shall be inserted into a spiral or convolute wound chipboard tube having the following dimensions: Inside diameter 6.90 + .015; outside diameter 7.28 - .015; length 6.00 - .050 inches. The tube winding shall be secured with dextrin or polyvinyl adhesive and the inside wall surface shall be smooth. Each grain shall be placed in the fiber drum with the inhibitor end up. A separator shall be placed between layers and on top of final layer. The separator shall be corrugated cardboard liners or separators, double-faced, 'B' or 'C' Flute, 200-pound test board. The bag shall be folded and sealed with tape meeting the requirements of PPP-T-60. Filler constructed of the same material as the separators shall be placed on top of the contents as required to provide a tight pack. The fiber drum cover shall be sealed with 2-inch minimum wide tape meeting the requirements of PPP-T-76. All packing material inside the barrier bag shall not exceed 7 percent maximum moisture content.

5.2 Marking.-The fiber drum shall be marked as follows:

DOT marking on top - "PROPELLANT EXPLOSIVES (SOLID) CLASS B"

on sidewall - "8 GRAIN, PROPELLANT, f/RAP 8-In,
XM650E5
DATE PACKED (MO/YR)
LOT NO (INSERT NO)
WT (INSERT WT) CU (INSERT VOLUME)"

Marking shall be with black waterproof ink and lettering shall be 1/4 inch minimum height.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended Use.-The components covered by this specification are intended for use on the 8" Rocket Assisted Projectile, XM650E5.

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6.2 Ordering Data.-See MIL-A-48078.

6.3 Submission of Inspection Procedures and/or Equipment Designs for Approval See MIL-A-48078.-Submit equipment designs as required, to Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, Attn: DRDAR-QAR-I, Dover, New Jersey 07801.

6.4 Base Grain Powder Test.-In the event AHH base grain powder has been in storage for one year or longer, the powder shall be requalified in accordance with Specification MIL-P-60432.

6.5 Submission of Test Data.-In addition to the normal distribution of records, one copy of all static and compression test data will be forwarded to, Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, Attn: DRDAR-QAR-Q and one copy to Attn: DRDAR-LCU-EP, Dover, New Jersey 07801.

6.6 Surveillance Sample.-Samples shall be forwarded to: Commander, US Army Armament Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRDAR-LCE-M, Dover, New Jersey 07801, for the propellant surveillance test program in accordance with MIL-STD-652. This sample shall contain propellant pieces not exceeding one inch in diameter which may include machine turnings, broken tensile specimens, or pieces of grain segments, but no inhibitor materials are to be included.

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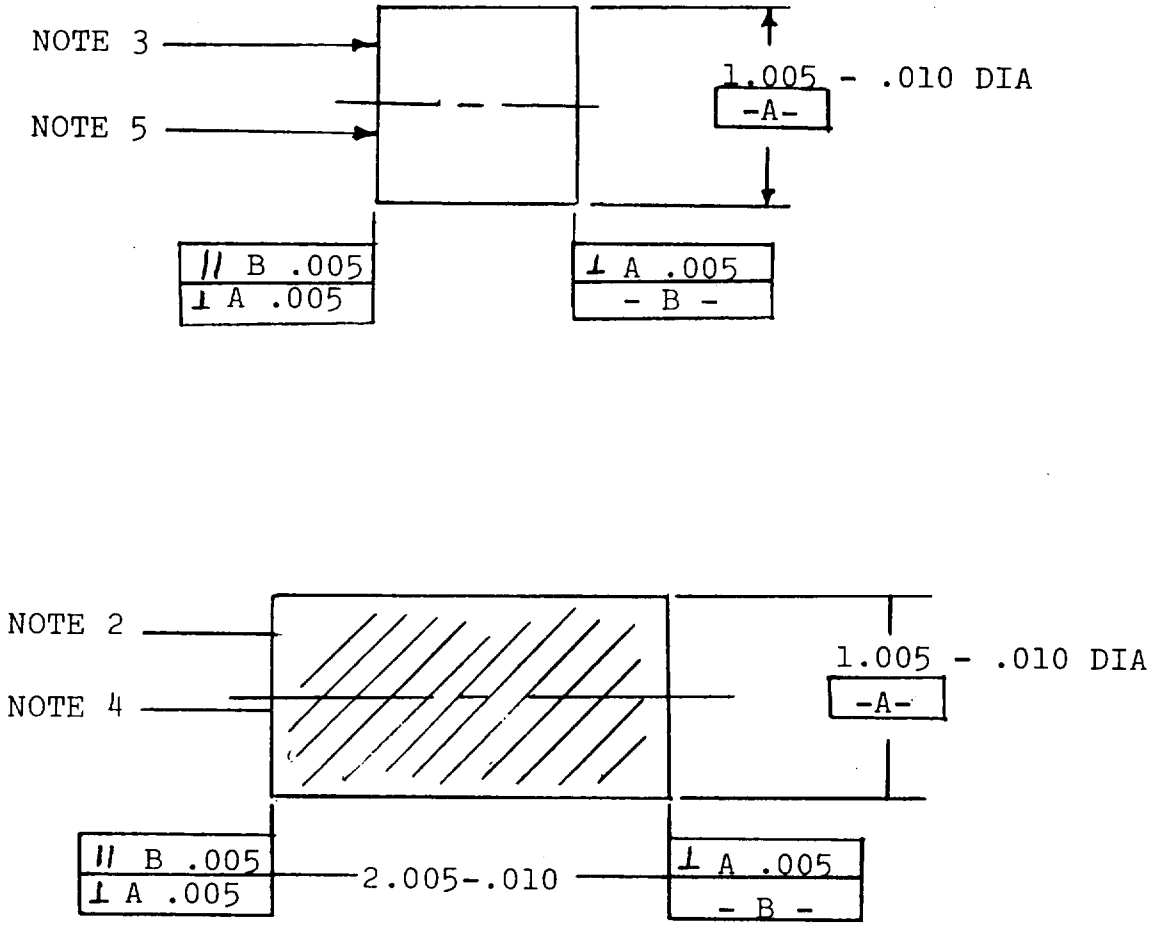
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FIGURE 1

GRAIN SPECIMEN AND SPECIMEN SUPPORTS FOR COMPRESSION TEST



NOTES

1. SPECIFICATION MIL-A-2550 APPLIES
2. SPECIMEN MATERIAL - SOLID PROPELLANT
3. TWO STEEL SPECIMEN SUPPORT REQUIRED AND SHALL BE PLACED ABOVE AND BELOW SPECIMEN PRIOR TO TEST
4. SURFACE FINISH - FINISH - 125 ALL OVER
5. SURFACE FINISH - FINISH - 125 ON PROPELLANT SURFACE

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 66 WHICH MAY BE USED

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